Table 5.03 Is R&D Spending Aimed at Today or Tomorrow?

	GERD (USD BILLIONS, CURRENT PPP)[1]				
	1994	2004	2014	2024	CHANGE
United States					
Basic research (for tomorrow)	$47.7B	$75.1B	$90.5B	$122B	**+156%**
Applied research (for today)	$58.9B	$92.4B	$100B	$153B	**+160%**
Experimental development (for today)	$165B	$236B	$329B	$570B	**+245%**
Capital expenditure (unallocated)	$0.665B	$1.46B	$1.13B	$2.72B	**+309%**
Total	**$273B**	**$405B**	**$521B**	**$848B**	**+211%**
China					
Basic research (for tomorrow)	$1.01B	$4.99B	$17.1B	$59.2B	**+5,780%**
Applied research (for today)	$4.98B	$17.1B	$38.9B	$102B	**+1,940%**
Experimental development (for today)	$12.3B	$61.7B	$306B	$698B	**+5,600%**
Total	**$18.2B**	**$83.8B**	**$362B**	**$859B**	**+4,610%**

[1] Spending levels in billions of US dollars, PPP converted, at current prices (not adjusted for inflation). Change is the relative change from the first to the last shown year. Basic research is investment in future capability; applied research and experimental development are nearer-term. Totals may not sum exactly because of rounding.

Data from OECD, Main Science and Technology Indicators (GERD, PPP), OECD.Stat, 1991–2024.
Chart by Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart, Stanford University.